

2018 英语 (一) Part A · Text 4

文章主题	通读后用一句话自行概括
限时阶段	18-22 分钟：先看题干，不看选项；读文不查词
笔译阶段	按段笔译、按段核对；先写粗译，不追求参考译文式中文
重做阶段	全文核对完成后，统一重做 36-40 题
第二天	遮住译文重读、重做题、复查错因与替换词

连续干净原文用于真实检测；笔译原文用于逐段输出；原文修改页用于在英文上订正。答案与解析请对照纸质版。

限时第一读：先看 5 个英文题干，不看选项

No.	Question stem - English only	Signal
36	The financial problem with the USPS is caused partly by	
37	According to Paragraph 2, the USPS fails to modernize itself due to	
38	The long-standing complaint by the USPS and its unions can be addressed by	
39	In the last paragraph, the author seems to view legislators with	
40	Which of the following would be the best title for the text?	

标出生词但不停下；标出转折/因果/让步；读到相关段落才回来看选项。

我的英文题干导航标记

干净原文 A：限时读文

现在开始计时。此处没有结构、词义或逻辑提示；读到相应段落，就做相应题目。

[P1] The U.S. Postal Service (USPS) continues to bleed red ink. It reported a net loss of \$5.6 billion for fiscal 2016, the 10th straight year its expenses have exceeded revenue. Meanwhile, it has more than \$120 billion in unfunded liabilities, mostly for employee health and retirement costs. There are many reasons this formerly stable federal institution finds itself on the verge of bankruptcy. Fundamentally, the USPS is in a historic squeeze between technological change that has permanently decreased demand for its bread-and-butter product, first-class mail, and a regulatory structure that denies management the flexibility to adjust its operations to the new reality.

[P2] And interest groups ranging from postal unions to greeting-card makers exert self-interested pressure on the USPS's ultimate overseer—Congress—insisting that whatever else happens to the Postal Service, aspects of the status quo they depend on get protected. This is why repeated attempts at reform legislation have failed in recent years, leaving the Postal Service unable to pay its bills except by deferring vital modernization.

[P3] Now comes word that everyone involved—Democrats, Republicans, the Postal Service, the unions and the system's heaviest users—has finally agreed on a plan to fix the system. Legislation is moving through the House that would save USPS an estimated \$28.6 billion over five years, which could help pay for new vehicles, among other survival measures. Most of the money would come from a penny-per-letter permanent rate increase and from shifting postal retirees into Medicare. The latter step would largely offset the financial burden of annually pre-funding retiree health care, thus addressing a long-standing complaint by the USPS and its unions.

[P4] If it clears the House, this measure would still have to get through the Senate—where someone is bound to point out that it amounts to the bare, bare minimum necessary to keep the Postal Service afloat, not comprehensive reform. There's no change to collective bargaining at the USPS, a major omission considering that personnel accounts for 80 percent of the agency's costs. Also missing is any discussion of eliminating Saturday letter delivery. That common-sense change enjoys wide public support and would save the USPS \$2 billion per year. But postal special-interest groups seem to have killed it, at least in the House. The emerging consensus around the bill is a sign that legislators are getting frightened about a politically embarrassing short-term collapse at the USPS. It is not, however, a sign that they're getting serious about transforming the postal system for the 21st century.

2.2

第一次做题：作答 36-40 题

现在才看选项。先独立完成五道题；需要时回原文定位。

36. The financial problem with the USPS is caused partly by

- [A] its unbalanced budget.
- [B] its rigid management.
- [C] the cost for technical upgrading.
- [D] the withdrawal of bank support.

37. According to Paragraph 2, the USPS fails to modernize itself due to

- [A] the interference from interest groups.
- [B] the inadequate funding from Congress.
- [C] the shrinking demand for postal service.
- [D] the incompetence of postal unions.

38. The long-standing complaint by the USPS and its unions can be addressed by

- [A] removing its burden of retiree health care.
- [B] making more investment in new vehicles.
- [C] adopting a new rate-increase mechanism.
- [D] attracting more first-class mail users.

39. In the last paragraph, the author seems to view legislators with

- [A] respect.
- [B] tolerance.
- [C] discontent.
- [D] gratitude.

40. Which of the following would be the best title for the text?

- [A] The USPS Starts to Miss Its Good Old Days
- [B] The Postal Service: Keep Away from My Cheese
- [C] The USPS: Chronic Illness Requires a Quick Cure
- [D] The Postal Service Needs More than a Band-Aid

3.1

第 1 段：逐句笔译与原文订正

直接在英文上标记主干和逻辑；长句留两行，短句留一行。

S1 The U.S. Postal Service (USPS) continues to bleed red ink.

S2 It reported a net loss of \$5.6 billion for fiscal 2016, the 10th straight year its expenses have exceeded revenue.

S3 Meanwhile, it has more than \$120 billion in unfunded liabilities, mostly for employee health and retirement costs.

S4 There are many reasons this formerly stable federal institution finds itself on the verge of bankruptcy.

S5 Fundamentally, the USPS is in a historic squeeze between technological change that has permanently decreased demand for its bread-and-butter product, first-class mail, and a regulatory structure that denies management the flexibility to adjust its operations to the new reality.

本段英语原文（按句分行）

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段落中心思想（用一句话概括）

3.2

第 2 段：逐句笔译与原文订正

直接在英文上标记主干和逻辑；长句留两行，短句留一行。

S1 And interest groups ranging from postal unions to greeting-card makers exert self- interested pressure on the USPS's ultimate overseer-Congress-insisting that whatever else happens to the Postal Service, aspects of the status quo they depend on get protected.

S2 This is why repeated attempts at reform legislation have failed in recent years, leaving the Postal Service unable to pay its bills except by deferring vital modernization.

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3.3

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S2 Legislation is moving through the House that would save USPS an estimated \$28.6 billion over five years, which could help pay for new vehicles, among other survival measures.

S3 Most of the money would come from a penny-per-letter permanent rate increase and from shifting postal retirees into Medicare.

S4 The latter step would largely offset the financial burden of annually pre-funding retiree health care, thus addressing a long-standing complaint by the USPS and its unions.

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S1 If it clears the House, this measure would still have to get through the Senate-where someone is bound to point out that it amounts to the bare, bare minimum necessary to keep the Postal Service afloat, not comprehensive reform.

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S3 Also missing is any discussion of eliminating Saturday letter delivery.

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S5 But postal special-interest groups seem to have killed it, at least in the House.

S6 The emerging consensus around the bill is a sign that legislators are getting frightened about a politically embarrassing short-term collapse at the USPS.

S7 It is not, however, a sign that they're getting serious about transforming the postal system for the 21st century.

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4

全文核对后：正式重做 36-40 题

再次独立作答。只看题干和选项；需要时回原文圈出定位句。

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5 原文 D：选项定位勾画

全篇核对后再读一遍原文；直接圈画每道题的定位句、关键词和同义替换。

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全文压缩与第二天复读

段落	段落功能	一句话压缩（自己写）
P1		
P2		
P3		
P4		

- ☐ 我能用 30 秒说清全文主线：
- ☐ 我能遮住答案重做 36-40：
- ☐ 我仍会错 / 不顺的点：
- ☐ 下次遇到相似结构，我要先看：